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Experiment No. 1

Perform Footprinting on the Target Network Using Search Engines, Web Services, and Social Networking Sites

AIM

To gather publicly available information about a target organization/network using passive reconnaissance techniques through search engines, web services, and social networking platforms, without directly interacting with the target's systems.

PROCEDURE

1. Identify the target organization/domain for the footprinting exercise.
2. Use advanced search engine operators (Google Dorking) such as site:, filetype:, intitle:, inurl: to locate publicly indexed pages, documents, and subdomains belonging to the target.
3. Use web services such as Netcraft, Shodan, and archive.org (Wayback Machine) to find hosting history, technology stack, and archived versions of the target website.
4. Search professional and social networking sites (LinkedIn, Twitter/X, Facebook) for employee names, designations, email formats, and organizational structure.
5. Use job portals and company career pages to identify technologies, software, and infrastructure used by the organization (from job requirements).
6. Compile all gathered information such as employee details, technologies used, subdomains, and public documents into a footprinting report.
7. Analyze the collected data to identify potential points of social engineering or technical exposure.

SAMPLE OUTPUT

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Google Dork used: site:targetcompany.com filetype:pdf
Result: 14 publicly indexed PDF documents found, including an internal policy
document and a vendor contract listing internal IP ranges.

Netcraft lookup for targetcompany.com:
  Hosting Provider : XYZ Cloud Services
  Netblock Owner    : XYZ Cloud Services Pvt Ltd
  Nameserver        : ns1.targetcompany.com

LinkedIn search 'targetcompany.com' revealed 230 employee profiles,
giving an email naming convention of firstname.lastname@targetcompany.com.

Wayback Machine showed 47 archived snapshots of the website since 2016,
revealing an older admin login page (/admin_old/) no longer linked publicly.
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RESULT

Publicly available information about the target organization, including subdomains, technologies, employee details, and archived pages, was successfully gathered using search engines, web

services, and social networking sites, demonstrating the risks of information disclosure through open-source intelligence (OSINT).